



University of Minnesota Extension

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Garden

Tomato > Leaves > Spots on leaves

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Flea Beetles

- Damage occurs during spring
- Small BB-sized pits or holes are chewed into leaves
- 1/16th inch beetles
- Small black beetles can jump

[More information on flea beetles](https://apps.extension.umn.edu/garden/diagnose/plant/vegetable/tomato/leavesspots.html?utm_source=chatgpt.com)



Septoria Leaf Spot

Septoria lycopersici

- Infects leaves, stems, petioles and sepals
- Small leaf spots (less than 1/8 inch in diameter)
- Spots have dark edge, with a tan or grey center
- Black dots appear in center of spot 8 days after spot first appears
- Most common with high humidity and temperatures 68° to 77° F

[More information on Septoria Leaf Spot](https://apps.extension.umn.edu/garden/diagnose/plant/vegetable/tomato/leavesspots.html?utm_source=chatgpt.com)



Early Blight

Alternaria solani

- Infects leaves, stems and fruit
- Black leathery spots on fruit start on stem end
- Dark irregular leaf spots, often surrounded by yellow tissue
- Sunken dark round stem lesion with concentric circles inside
- Occurs in warm wet weather, common at the end of summer

[More information on Early Blight](https://apps.extension.umn.edu/garden/diagnose/plant/vegetable/tomato/leavesspots.html?utm_source=chatgpt.com)



Bacterial Speck

Pseudomonas syringae pv. *tomato*

- Leaves have small (2 mm) black spots surrounded by yellow or light green halo
- Green and red fruit have small black spots (1 to 2 mm)
**Best way to distinguish from bacterial spot*
- Occurs in cool wet weather 64° to 75° F
- Difficult to see bacterial streaming

[More information on Bacterial Speck](#)

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Bacterial Spot

Xanthomonas campestris pv. *vesicatoria*

- Leaves have small (1 mm) black spots surrounded by yellow or light green halo
- Green and red fruit have large corky black spots (4 to 5 mm)
*Best way to distinguish from bacterial speck
- Fruit spots may have a white greasy looking halo
- Occurs in warm wet weather 75° to 86° F
- Difficult to see bacterial streaming

[More information on Bacterial Spot](#)

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Late Blight

Phytophthora infestans

- Irregular water-soaked lesions on leaves, turn olive then brown
- Leaves, stems and petioles turn brown and shrivel

- Fruit spot is round olive colored, can cover whole fruit
- Infected tissue is covered with white mycelia in wet weather
- Disease spreads very rapidly in cool wet weather

[More information on Late Blight](#)

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Verticillium Wilt

Verticillium albo-atrum, *Verticillium dahlia*

- A yellow wedge shaped lesion on leaf often with a brown center
- Leaves yellow and wilt, often one side only
- Lower leaves wilt first, eventually whole plant wilts

- In a lengthwise cut of the stem near the soil line, veins are tan, center is green
- Common in cool temperatures 68° to 75° F

[More information on Verticillium Wilt](#)

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